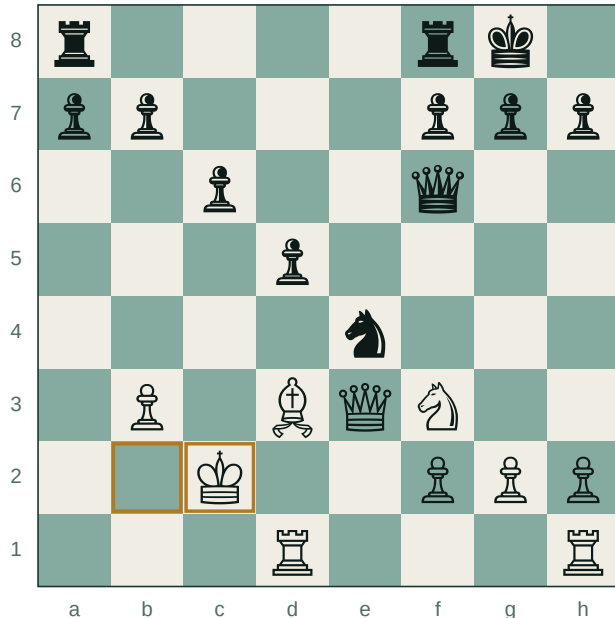


Deflection tactics: Black, move 18

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 18.Kc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18...Qc3+ 19. Kb1 Qxb3+

18...Qc3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From c3 it attacks king on c2 and bishop on d3. Recorded reply: **19.Kb1**.

19...Qxb3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From b3 it attacks king on b1, rook on d1 and bishop on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on c2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.